

HTML & CSS Reference Guide

A concise guide to essential tags and properties with examples

HTML Tags

<h1 – h6> — Heading tags, from largest (h1) to smallest (h6)

Code:

```
<h1>Main Heading</h1> <h2>Sub Heading</h2> <h3>Section</h3>
```

Rendered:

Main Heading
Sub Heading
Section

<p> — Paragraph — wraps a block of text

Code:

```
<p>This is a paragraph of text.</p>
```

Rendered:

This is a paragraph of text.

<a> — Anchor — creates a hyperlink

Code:

```
<a href="https://example.com">Visit Example</a>
```

Rendered:

[Visit Example](https://example.com)

** — Image — embeds an image**

Code:

```

```

Rendered:

[Image: A photo — 300px wide]

<ul / ol / li> — Lists — unordered (bullets) or ordered (numbers)

Code:

```
<ul> <li>Apples</li> <li>Bananas</li> </ul>
```

Rendered:

- Apples
- Bananas

<table / tr / td> — Table structure — rows and cells

Code:

```
<table> <tr><th>Name</th><th>Age</th></tr> <tr><td>Alice</td><td>30</td></tr> </table>
```

Rendered:

Name	Age
Alice	30

<div> — Block-level container for grouping elements

Code:

```
<div class="card"> <h2>Title</h2> <p>Content here</p> </div>
```

Rendered:

Title

Content here

 — Inline container for styling a portion of text

Code:

```
<p>Price: <span style="color:red">$9.99</span></p>
```

Rendered:

Price: \$9.99

<form / input / button> — Form elements for user input

Code:

```
<form> <input type="text" placeholder="Your name"> <button  
type="submit">Submit</button> </form>
```

Rendered:

[Text field: Your name] [Button: Submit]

<b / strong> — Bold text — visual, semantic importance

Code:

```
<b>Bold text</b> and <strong>important text</strong>
```

Rendered:

Bold text and **important text**

<i / em> — Italic text — <i> visual, semantic emphasis

Code:

```
<i>Italic text</i> and <em>emphasized</em>
```

Rendered:

Italic text and *emphasized*

<br / hr> — Line break and horizontal rule

Code:

```
First line<br>Second line<hr>Below the line
```

Rendered:

First line
Second line
■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■■
Below the line

CSS Properties

<color> — Sets the text color (name, hex, rgb, hsl)

Code:

```
p { color: #e63946; } h2 { color: rgb(0, 119, 182); }
```

Rendered:

This text is red-ish. This text is blue.

<background-color> — Sets the background color of an element

Code:

```
div { background-color: #ffd166; } span { background-color: #06d6a0; }
```

Rendered:

[Yellow box] [Green highlight]

<font-size> — Controls the size of text

Code:

```
small { font-size: 12px; } big { font-size: 24px; }
```

Rendered:

Small text (12px) **Big text (24px)**

<font-weight> — Sets text boldness (normal, bold, 100–900)

Code:

```
p.light { font-weight: 300; } p.bold { font-weight: 700; }
```

Rendered:

Light weight text **Bold weight text**

<margin / padding> — margin = space outside; padding = space inside

Code:

```
.box { margin: 20px; padding: 10px; border: 1px solid #ccc; }
```

Rendered:

[Box with 20px outer space, 10px inner space, border]

<border> — Adds a border: width, style, color

Code:

```
div { border: 2px solid #333; border-radius: 8px; }
```

Rendered:

[Rounded rectangle with solid border]

<display> — Controls layout type: block, inline, flex, grid, none

Code:

```
.row { display: flex; gap: 10px; } .hidden { display: none; }
```

Rendered:

[Items aligned in a row] [Hidden element invisible]

<flexbox> — Powerful 1-D layout model for alignment

Code:

```
.container { display: flex; justify-content: center; align-items: center; gap: 16px; }
```

Rendered:

[Children centered horizontally and vertically with 16px gaps]

<position> — Controls element positioning: static, relative, absolute, fixed

Code:

```
.tooltip { position: absolute; top: 0; right: 0; }
```

Rendered:

[Tooltip pinned to top-right corner of its parent]

<transition> — Animates CSS property changes smoothly

Code:

```
button { background: blue; transition: background 0.3s ease; } button:hover {  
background: darkblue; }
```

Rendered:

[Button smoothly fades to dark blue on hover over 0.3 seconds]

CSS Selectors

Selector	Selects	Example
*	Every element	<code>* { box-sizing: border-box; }</code>
element	All of that tag	<code>p { color: gray; }</code>
.class	Elements with that class	<code>.btn { padding: 8px; }</code>
#id	One unique element	<code>#header { height: 60px; }</code>
a, b	Both a and b	<code>h1, h2 { font-family: sans-serif; }</code>
a b	b inside a	<code>nav a { color: white; }</code>
a > b	Direct child b of a	<code>ul > li { list-style: none; }</code>
a:hover	a when hovered	<code>button:hover { opacity: 0.8; }</code>
a::before	Before content of a	<code>li::before { content: '✓'; }</code>

HTML provides the **structure**, CSS provides the **style**. Together they form the foundation of every webpage.